International Teacher Education

Reading notes

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Professional Studies Reading Notes: Classroom & Behavior Management

Module / Topic: LTSS Classroom & Behavior Management

Readings Covered:

- Tom Bennett, *Running the Room*, Chapters 7 & 8
- Educational Studies LTSS Sections 2.1, 3.1 & 3.2
- Active Learning Frameworks in Behavioral Management

1. Summary of Core Concepts

A. Tom Bennett – Running the Room

Chapter 7: Routines

- **Definition:** Routines are repeated actions that help lessons run smoothly. Examples include entering the classroom, getting students' attention and handing in work.
- **Why they are important:** When students know what to do, they do not have to think about every small action. This leaves more attention and working memory available for learning.
- **Teaching routines:** Routines should be explained clearly and taught step by step. The teacher should demonstrate what is expected, check if students understand and give them time to practise.
- **Five stages:** Design → Describe → Demonstrate → Demand → Disengage. The goal is for routines to become automatic, so students can follow them without needing constant reminders.

Chapter 8: Rules & Expectations

- **Definition:** Classroom rules are a small set of clear expectations that show students which behaviours are acceptable.
- **Good rules:** Rules should be easy to understand and describe behaviour that can actually be seen. It is also better to explain what students should do instead of only telling them what not to do.
- **Consistency:** Bennett explains that "You promote what you permit." This means that if a teacher allows certain behaviour without correcting it, students may start to see it as normal.
- **Main takeaway:** Rules only work when teachers apply them consistently and make sure students understand what is expected.

B. LTSS Theoretical Frameworks (Sections 2.1, 3.1 & 3.2)

Section 2.1: Cognitive Architecture & Environment

- Working memory has limited capacity. When students have to deal with unclear instructions or distractions, it becomes harder for them to focus on the lesson.
- Clear routines and expectations can reduce unnecessary distractions.
- A predictable classroom environment can help students feel more comfortable and focus better on learning.

Section 3.1: Behavior as a Special Educational Need / Equity

- Students can have different levels of self-control, emotional regulation and organisational skills.
- Some students need more structure and support to manage their behaviour.
- Clear routines and expectations can help these students participate in lessons. This is especially important for students who struggle with self-regulation or need more predictability.

Section 3.2: Behavior as Communication

- Challenging or off-task behaviour can sometimes be a way for students to show that something is wrong. For example, they might be frustrated, struggling with the subject or feeling uncomfortable.
- Teachers should try to understand the reason behind the behaviour instead of only reacting to what they see.
- It is important to stay calm and focus on the behaviour itself. Correcting a student privately when possible can also help avoid embarrassing them in front of the class.

C. Active Learning & Behavior Management

- **Active Student Response (ASR):** Students should be actively involved during lessons instead of only listening. Examples include pair discussions, mini-whiteboard activities and cold-calling.
- **Keeping students engaged:** When students have something to do and are actively thinking about the subject, there is less time for distractions.
- **Main takeaway:** Active learning can also help with classroom management because students are more involved in the lesson.

2. Theoretical Analysis & Key Themes

Theme	Key Insight from the Readings	Practical Application in a History Classroom
Cognitive Load	Working memory is limited, and unclear instructions or distractions make learning harder.	Start lessons with a short activity on the board. Students enter quietly, get their books and start working.
Behavioural Instruction	Behaviour is something students can learn, just like academic skills.	Explain and demonstrate how students should discuss historical sources before letting them work in groups.
Consistency	If certain behaviour is allowed repeatedly, students may start thinking it is acceptable.	Use the same signal to get students' attention and consistently address talking during explanations.
Active Engagement	Students are less likely to become distracted when they are actively involved in the lesson.	Use cold-calling, short discussions and mini-whiteboards when reviewing historical topics.

3. Reflection & Pedagogical Implications

Key Takeaway for Teaching Practice:

One thing I took from these readings is that classroom management is not just about correcting students when they misbehave. It is also about preventing problems by making sure students know what is expected of them. Clear routines and rules can make the classroom more organised and give students a better environment to learn in. At the same time, teachers should remember that behaviour can have different causes and that some students need more support than others.

Personal Target for Internship:

During my internship, I want to focus on building clear routines from the beginning. For example, I want to practise how students enter the classroom, how I get their attention and how materials are handed out. I also want to be consistent with classroom rules, so students know what to expect from me and what I expect from them.